

Narayan Ashanahalli

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Interaction designer focused on spatial interactions — building systems that understand physical context and respond to the humans within it. Grounded in strong design and systems thinking, I work through building and prototyping tangible interfaces. Looking to join a lean, technical team building the next generation of foundational tools.

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University

Pittsburgh, PA

Master of Advanced Architectural Design,

May 2026

Relevant Coursework: Designing AI Products, AI Augmented Designer, Introduction to Deep Learning, Building User-Centered Sensing Systems, Spatial Interaction Design, Customer Discovery for Tech Innovation

JNAFA University

Hyderabad, IN

Bachelor of Architecture

July 2023

WORK EXPERIENCE

UX Designer & Researcher

December 2024 – Present

Lab 4 Cybernetics | Carnegie Mellon University

- Led the design and development of the Lab's foundational digital infrastructure — a full-stack platform with a Notion-based CMS built for long-term maintainability.
- Shipped an AI-powered matchmaking feature based on research interests and expertise within the platform with 25+ active practitioners and scholars.
- Built a spatial graph archive for the Cybernetics of Cybernetics book — mapping 200+ systems literature nodes into an interactive spatial structure making dense conceptual relationships navigable.

Project Designer

August 2023 – July 2024

Studio Chintala | Bangalore, India

- Led research, concepting, and delivery of 'Working, Living & Innovating' — a strategic design report for industrial campus translating behavioral field research into a phased design strategy, securing Phase I approval for execution.
- Developed a systems-based intervention framework across 5 spatial domains, presenting cost-tiered prototypes to stakeholders and driving alignment between human experience goals and operational constraints.

Machine Learning Intern

August 2020 – December 2020

Uniworks Design | Hyderabad, India

- Constructed training dataset for ArP-Gen GAN model: validated 2,000+ architectural floor plans with feature labels.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Interaction Designer | Pointobot

August 2025 – Present

Master's Thesis

- Built a 2-DOF laser mechanism (lab assistant) with voice input and LLM-based spatial reasoning — physically pointing to real-world locations in a shared lab environment as a primary communication channel.
- Investigated pointing as an interaction paradigm — designing for a world where AI references physical space directly rather than describing it through language.
- Developed a responsive gesture library for communicating robot state through physical movement, removing the need for screen or voice output.

Product Designer | [Dot Threads](#)

November 2025 – January 2026

Browser Extension for Knowledge Management

- Designed and shipped browser extension exploring spatial approaches to knowledge management prototyped from Vannevar Bush's MEMEX, currently live on Chrome Web Store with +10 active users.
- Shipped 4 click workflow and graph-based canvas for organizing web links by context and relationships.

Interaction Designer | [Piko](#)

March 2025 – May 2025

Context-Aware Wearable Assistant

- Designed a soft robotic companion detecting doom-scrolling posture with 91% accuracy using a custom-trained computer vision model, delivering peripheral physical feedback as a habit-building nudge.
- Developed an emotive gesture library translating four behavioral states into physical servo movements — curiosity, joy, shyness, anger — creating social feedback without language.
- Trained a custom CV model on 400+ images using Roboflow, distributed across a three-node Raspberry Pi architecture for low-latency accurate real-time response.

SKILLS

Design: User Research, Product Strategy, Interaction Design, Information Architecture, Prototyping, Wireframing, Visual Design, Systems Thinking, Project Management, Data Visualization, Survey Design, Product Ownership

Tools: Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, Framer, Sketch, Rhino 3D

Technical: HTML/CSS/JavaScript, React, TypeScript, Python, GitHub, API integration, AI-Assisted Prototyping